

Looking for work outside

Unit 1

Job seeking



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TP_Work outside_JobSeeking_U1Amir

TP_Work outside_JobSeeking_U1Adi

TP_Work outside_JobSeeking_U1Dushan

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Overview

This is the first of three units intended to introduce the language learners will need for finding work when they are released. They will talk about the kind of work they like and dislike and then consider what kinds of jobs may suit them. Literacy skills will be developed through reading and understanding the language of job advertisements.

Level : ESOL Entry 1-3; National 2- 4, CEFR A1-B1

Time: 95 minutes

Aims

- to talk about likes and dislikes and see how these can relate to job choice
- to discuss the process of finding a job on release from prison
- to understand vocabulary commonly found in job ads
- to read a number of texts relating to job search

Objectives

All learners will be able to;

- use key words to communicate job titles
- use *I like* and *I don't like* to express preferences
- understand 5 phrases connected to job search
- understand a limited number of words relating to job ads
- match written job titles to pictures of jobs

Entry 1/National 2 learners will be able to;

- read and extract key information from job ads

Entry 2/National 3 and above learners will be able to:

- identify areas of interest to help them choose appropriate jobs, using *like / don't like / don't mind* and *can/can't*
- state at least 5 steps they can take to help find a job outside
- understand vocabulary relating to job search and job ads
- read 5 short job ads for jobs commonly taken by ex-offenders and answer specific questions
- read 5 short job ads and select a job of interest

NB: Differentiated activities are given to stretch higher-level learners.



Preparation

You will need:

- **Resource 1** – one set of job images in colour (if possible) to be displayed or printed on A3
- **Resource 2** – list of activities, one set for each group of three / four learners, cut into strips
- Handwriting paper or lined paper
- **Resource 3** – audio or audio script for reading aloud
- **Resource 4** – job search activities, one set for each group of three / four learners, cut up into strips
- **Resource 5** – job search activities, one copy for each Pre-entry learner
- **Resource 6** – job ads, one or two copies, stuck up around the classroom walls prior to the lesson
- **Resource 7** – matching, one copy for every E 2 / N3 learner and above
- **Resource 8** – table, one copy for every E 1 / N2 learner
- **Resource 9** – questions, one copy for every E 2 / N3 learner and above

Consider:

- Bring in real examples of a CV, application form and covering letter to help you explain these terms in Activity 2.
- Some learners may have had negative experiences of job search in the past and may feel pessimistic about looking for a job on release. Reassure the learners that the next few lessons will help them with this and tell them that there are many organisations dedicated to helping ex-offenders find work, e.g. Working Chance, the Prince's Trust, Unlock.

Unit 1: Looking for a job

Warmer: Thinking about work outside (10 minutes)

- As a warmer, ask your learners to imagine a line running from left to right at the front of the classroom. The left-hand end of the line is 0% the right-hand end is 100%; 50% is the middle of the line.
- Ask your learners what job they want to do when they leave prison. Tell them if they are sure about what they want to do to stand at the 100% mark, if they have no idea to stand at the 0% mark, if they have a few ideas (but are not sure) to stand in the middle and so on.
- When learners are in place, ask them to tell the person next to them what job they are thinking of (or if they have no idea, what job they do now and if they would like to do it outside).
- After the activity, present the session objectives in language appropriate to your learners' level of English.

Differentiation

Encourage higher level learners to explain the reasons for the jobs they have mentioned.

Learning check

Monitor and assist. This activity helps you to gauge the learners' interest and confidence in the topic area, as well as informally assessing their vocabulary for job titles / talking about jobs.

Activity 1: Pre-teach vocabulary – People and their skills (15 minutes)

Note: This activity follows on nicely from the teacher's pack 'Working and studying in prison' Unit 1, though it is not necessary to have done this previously.

- Seat your learners so the Pre-entry and E1/N2 learners are sitting together, but all other levels are mixed.
- Ask the learners what jobs they do in prison.
- Option: If you have recently completed the teacher's pack 'Working and studying in prison' Unit 1, ask learners to tell you three of their duties by way of a recap.
- Show them the images in **Resource 1** and explain that these are the first jobs people often do when they leave prison. Elicit the job titles. Accept any reasonable answers, but write up and drill *cleaner, kitchen staff, recycling operative, office assistant, gardener, support worker* (as these are terms used in Activity 6) and *cashier*.
- Check learners know what a syllable is. Do this by clapping out the syllables in your name and in the names of some of your students.

- Ask higher level learners (E2 and above) to decide how many syllables are in each of the job titles on the board. While they do this, check lower-level learners can recognise and say the job titles. Drill again. If necessary, Pre-entry learners can prioritise seven key words; *cleaner, kitchen, recycling, office, garden, support* and *cashier*.
- Get feedback on syllables from higher level learners.
- Display and read aloud a phrase from **Resource 2**, e.g. *use a computer* and ask which of the jobs you could do if you were good at this. (e.g. *office assistant*)
- Distribute **Resource 2**, one set per group of three or four learners and ask them to say which of the 7 jobs you could do if you were good at the phrase on each card.

Differentiation

- Give Pre-entry learners fewer cards, e.g. *clean / use a computer / cook / do the garden and talk to other people*.
- Beginner readers focus on the letter 'c' for the /k/ sound. Write c on the board and drill as the /k/ sound (Don't use the letter name or the phonetic symbol). Give examples of words beginning with c for the /k/sound, e.g. class, coffee, cold. See if your learners can think of others. Write out the words *clean, cook, and computer* on some handwriting paper. Read the words with the learners and check they understand the meaning. Learners copy the words then read them back to you. Ask them which job each word matches (e.g. clean – cleaner, cook – kitchen staff, computer – office assistant)
- Ask higher level learners who finish quickly to think of other things the people that do these jobs must be good at.

Learning check

- Learners have an opportunity to check unfamiliar vocabulary with their classmates during the activity.
- Monitor. Ask questions to check meaning, e.g. '*Which one means 'wash clothes'?*' '*Keep track of...*' will probably be new to most learners. Ask '*Do I know how much money I have? Do I write it down?*'
- After a few minutes, ask for ideas from nominated groups. Accept any reasonable answers, e.g. *help people with their problems – support worker; keep track of my money – cashier*.

Activity 2 Grammar focus – What do you like doing? (20 minutes)

- Take a set of **Resource 2** cards. Read out some of the things you like or don't like doing using the cards as cues. Use the target language, e.g. *I like using a computer. I don't like doing the garden*. Use gesture or draw two faces (smiling and frowning) to explain *like* and *don't like* to Pre-entry learners.



- Ask learners to listen to the audio (**Resource 3**) ~~for a first time~~ and decide on a job for each of the three people. Accept any reasonable answers (e.g. Amir – cleaner or kitchen staff, Adi – office assistant or cashier, Dushan – support worker).
- Learners listen a second time and say what people like or don't like doing. Lower level learners might only pick up on one or two things, whilst higher-level learners may pick out language which you haven't pre-taught, e.g. 'don't mind cleaning' and 'enjoy working with others'. Don't insist on grammatical accuracy during feedback. (Answers: Amir **likes** cooking and preparing food and **doesn't mind** cleaning or washing up, Adi **doesn't like** cleaning or laundry but **likes** working with numbers, using a computer and enjoys working with others, Dushan **likes** talking to others and helping people)
- Write or display on the board;

- ☐ I like cooking.
 - ☐ I like to cooking.
 - ☐ I like cook.

- Play the audio of Amir speaking for a third time and then ask the learners to discuss which of the sentences on the board is correct.
- Get feedback and drill examples of the target language, including phrases with 'I don't like...'
- Ask the learners to put the **Resource 2** cards upside down in a pile and take it in turns to turn over the top card. They must say one true sentence using the phrase on the card and I like / don't like. Note that some of the cards, e.g. drive / use a computer, lend themselves better to can / can't. Remove these cards for lower level learners and see differentiation note for higher level learners.
- Collect all the packs of **Resource 2** back in.
- Option: Give each learner just one card from **Resource 2** and demonstrate that they must walk round the room holding the card so it faces away from them.
- Carry out a 'mill drill'; learners circulate the room. They must talk to everyone; every time they meet someone, they must make a sentence using the target language and the language on that person's card.
- After five minutes, draw the activity to a close. Collect **Resource 2**. Ask learners to think about which of the jobs in the **Resource 1** images they would like to do based on what they like / don't like doing. Ask them to tell the people in their group.

Differentiation

- Pre-entry and Entry 1 learners work produce sentences with like / don't like only. Reduce the number of **Resource 2** cards you give them.



- Entry 2 and above use *like / don't mind / don't like and can / can't*. Use gesture or draw three faces (smiling, neutral and frowning) to check the meaning of 'don't mind' (compared to *like / don't like*). Use gesture (shrug your shoulders) or pictures (e.g. a car crossed out) to explain 'can't' (*I can't drive*) and highlight the use of the verb without *ing*.
- Learners who finish early can write three or four sentences about themselves using the target language. Ask them the rule for writing the verbs *use / prepare / drive*. (When a verb ends in *consonant +e*, remove the *e* before adding *ing*.)

Learning check

- Encourage learners to check and correct each other's sentences.
- Monitor and draw attention to commonly occurring errors in feedback.

Follow up /extension activities

- This target language will be useful in Unit 3 of this teacher's pack.
- As a warmer / filler in subsequent lessons, give a confident learner a few cards from **Resource 2** and ask him / her to say '*I like, I don't mind,*' etc. plus the phrases on the cards. Other learners shout out job suggestions.
- As an extension, learners could write questionnaires or surveys to find out about the activities the class members like using the question form *Do you like...?*

Activity 3 Discussing the stages of job search (15 minutes)

- Regroup learners so they are sitting with learners of similar English level.
- Write these words on the board and check their meanings; *job club, interview, CV, covering letter, application form, vacancies, ads*. Use authentic examples of a CV, application form and covering letter to help you do this and where possible, elicit explanations from learners who have experience of job hunting in the UK.

Note that a CV might be an unfamiliar concept to some learners. Explain that a CV is a document with all your personal information (elicit examples, e.g. name, address, telephone) and information about jobs and education you have had in the past. Reassure them that they will have the chance to write their own CV in another session (Unit 2 of this pack).

- Demonstrate **Resource 4** by drawing four columns on the board and writing the headings at the top of each; *Before you start looking, Looking for a job, Applying for a job, Before you go for an interview*. Read an example from Resource 4 and ask learners which heading it comes under.
- Distribute **Resource 4** – one set to each group of three or four learners. Learners work together to categorise the stages of job search.

Differentiation



- **Pre-entry / Entry**

Once the other learners are engaged in the categorising activity, drill the phrases on **Resource 5** with your lower-level learners. They then match the pictures to the words and finally tick if they have done these things before. They can also fold under the words and try to remember one phrase for each picture.

- **Entry 3 and above**

Give E3/N4 learners the headings only (from **Resource 4**) and ask them to brainstorm ideas for each heading.

Learning check

At the end of the activity, display or give each group an intact copy of **Resource 4** to check their answers.

Conduct whole class feedback. Refer back to the headings on the board. Ask nominated groups of learners to give you one or two examples of things you do for each heading.

Activity 4 Talking about job search (10 minutes)

- Still in their level groups, learners look at **Resource 4** again (now categorised). They tell each other (1) if they have experience of this in their language or in English and (2) if they think it is easy or difficult to do in English. Encourage E 2/N3 and above to give reasons, e.g. *I think application forms are difficult because you have to have good spelling. I think interviews are easy because I'm good at speaking and listening.*

Note that some learners may be reluctant to talk about their strengths and weaknesses. Highlight that it is important to think about what you are good at and what you need to improve, and that it will also help you, as their teacher, understand how to help them in future classes. Give examples of things that you personally find easy and difficult to demonstrate the point. At all times, however, be aware of sensitivities and accept that some learners are happy just to listen to others rather than share their reasons.

- As you monitor, note which aspects learners seem least confident with and consider covering them in future lessons.
- After discussion, assure learners that you will be covering some of these activities in the next few lessons and today you will focus on job ads.

Differentiation

- Pre-entry learners are likely to say everything is difficult. As an alternative activity, focus on **Resource 5** again. Ask 'Can you do this in your language?' Learners circle the things they can do in their first language, then tell their partner. If they seem confident, ask 'Can you do this in English?' Learners tick the things they can do in English (which may be only one or two things, e.g. fill in a form) and tell their partner.



Activity 5 Vocabulary for job ads (10 minutes)

- Display job ad 1 from **Resource 6** and ask learners what is it (*a CV? a form? a job ad?*) Ask why you would read it (*to look for a job*) and what jobs they can see (*kitchen staff and cleaners*).
- Draw attention to some of the vocabulary, e.g. *volunteer, part-time, training* and ask learners if they know what these words means. Explain that these are words you often find in job ads and that you are going to look at more vocabulary you might see.
- Pair up learners and distribute **Resource 7**. Give learners a few minutes to match the word to its meaning by drawing a line.

Differentiation

- **Pre-entry / Entry 1 / National 2**

Whilst the others are completing **Resource 7**, sit with lower-level learners and teach and drill the words *volunteer* and *paid, wages, phone number* and *email* which they need for the next activity. For example;

- Show a picture, e.g. of the cleaners, from **Resource 1**. Demonstrate counting out money onto the table. Elicit the word '*money*' and say '*wages – money for a job*'.
- Write down examples of a phone number and an email address. Elicit or teach *phone number* and *email*. Ask which one you use a computer for.
- For *volunteer* and *paid*, show two pictures of people doing jobs (perhaps the office assistants in **Resource 1**). Point to them and say '*At the end of the week, she gets money, she is paid.*' '*He helps. He works for free. He doesn't get money. He is a volunteer.*'

Write out each word and have the learners read them.

- **Entry 2 / National 3 and above**

Fold **Resource 7** where indicated. E 2 / N 3 learners match the top half (where options are limited to five meanings). E 3 / N 4 learners match the bottom half.

Learning check

Learners check together. Ask for whole class feedback.

Activity 6 Reading job ads (20 minutes)

- Draw learners' attention to the job ads from **Resource 6** which you have stuck up around the class prior to the lesson.
- Explain that they are going to read the job ads and find some information. This is a differentiated activity.



Differentiation

- **Pre-entry**

Pre-entry learners work together as a group. Give them the job flashcards (**Resource 1**). They must stick the picture of the job next to the job ad. When finished, ask them to read the ads and find three examples of wages (money) and two phone numbers.

- **Entry 1 / National 2**

Entry 1 learners work individually. Give each a copy of **Resource 8**. They must circulate the room, read the ads and fill in the table.

- **Entry 2 / National 3 and above**

Learners work individually. Give each a copy of **Resource 9**. They read the job ads and answer the first six questions. Faster readers and Entry 3 may attempt the extra questions, and then look for examples of the vocabulary from Activity 5 in the job ads.

Learning check

- Learners of same English level check their answers together.
- Feedback to the whole group: focus on each job ad and elicit selected answers to questions that all level learners might have answered to the whole class. Direct a few specific questions at learners of each level.
- Option: Give out the answer sheet and have learners check their own answers.

Cooler (5 minutes)

Ask learners to go and stand by the job ad that they would most like to apply for. They tell the person next to them why they would like to apply. This gives learners the opportunity to recycle language from Activity 2.

Follow up / extension activities

- Bring in authentic job ads from the local area, or from websites specialising in employing ex-offenders. Design a reading activity similar to Activity 6.
- Ask learners with good writing skills to write a job ad for their dream job. Stick the ads up on the wall. The class votes for the best job.
- Play vocabulary games with job ad-related vocabulary as a recap in future lessons.

Resource 1 – Flashcards





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Looking for work outside Unit 1: Job seeking – teachers' pack



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Resource 2 What I like

✂ Cut up enough so every group of three or four learners has one set.

do the garden

talk to other people

clean

do laundry

use a computer

keep my English file tidy

work with numbers

keep track of my money

drive

listen to other people

prepare food

cook



Resource 3 Transcript for audio

(Man): *Hi. I'm Amir. I'm leaving in 3 months and I'm not sure what I'll do when I get out. I like cooking and preparing food and I don't mind cleaning or washing up. Maybe I could...(fade out)*

(Woman): *Hello. My name is Adi. I've got some idea about what I'd like to do when I leave. I don't like cleaning or laundry. I like working with numbers and using a computer...and I enjoy working with other people. I think I'm going to apply for jobs in...(fade out)*

(Man): *I'm Dushan. I like talking to other people and helping them with their problems. When I was inside, I had my own problems and one person really helped me. I think I'd like to do the same...*

Resource 4 Steps

Before you start looking

think about your skills and what kind of job you want to do

join a job club

prepare your CV

Looking for a job

look at job ads in the jobcentre

go to workplaces and ask if they have vacancies

look at job ads online

look at job ads in the newspaper

Applying for a job

fill in an application form

re-write your CV

send an application form and a covering letter

send your CV

Before you go for an interview

practise your interview skills with a friend or at job club

think about your clothes

think of some questions to ask

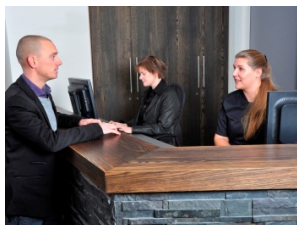
Resource 5 I need to:



Fold here
↓



go to the job centre



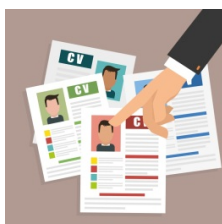
read job ads



look online



ask about a job



fill in a form



send my CV

Resource 6 – Job ads

1

Volunteers needed for homeless shelter

We need part-time **kitchen staff** to prepare and serve food and **cleaners** to clean dorms and wash bed linen and towels.

- **10 hours a week minimum**
- **Full training given**
- **Learn new skills and meet people**
- **Travel expenses paid**

Please contact Deb via email deb@redroofcharity.co.uk or come and see us on Park Road.

Resource 6 Job ads

2

Gardening and grounds maintenance



We require a part-time gardener to work in Herdwick Park.

- £7.20 ph
- 20 hours a week (5 days a week)
- temporary contract (April to October)

You will have some experience in gardening and be able to work as part of a small team.

Telephone Mandy on 07778 63215 or email
mandy@herdwickpark.abl.co.uk

We are an equal opportunities employer and welcome applications from ex-offenders.

Resource 6 Job ads

3

Full-time Recycling Operatives

37 hours a week

£7.73 an hour

Full-time, temporary (1 year)



Duties include;

- sorting plastics, cans and paper
- collecting furniture and appliances
- cleaning and maintaining working area
- following strict health and safety rules

You must have a driving licence.

Full training given.

Email to apply

Resource 6 Job ads

4

Support worker

Help people with drug and alcohol problems

We require support workers to give one-to-one support to people recovering from drug and alcohol addiction.

We offer;

- £7.52 an hour
- 15+ hours a week
- Min. 3 days a week.
- Permanent contract
- Training

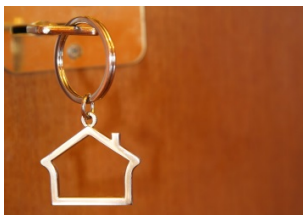
You must be caring and with excellent listening skills.

Please email maleka@drugandalcohol.support.co.uk to request an application form.

Resource 6

5

Volunteer office assistant



- Are you organised?
- Are you good at working with others?
- Can you use a computer?
- Do you want to learn new skills?
- Can you work for 15 hours a week?

Maybe this is the volunteer job for you!

Re: is a resettlement charity which helps people to find accommodation after their release from prison. We need volunteers to help with admin tasks in our office in Green Lane. If you'd like more information, please contact Khalil on 02709 321765.

Resource 7 - What does it mean? Match the word to the meaning.

volunteer
permanent
temporary
part-time
full-time

a job which is 35 hours or more every week
a job which you have for a long time
a person who does a job but does not get any money for it
a job which is less than 35 hours every week
a job which you have for a short time

contact
application form
ph
duties
training

the things you have to do in your job
per hour (every hour)
the things they teach you to help you do a job
a form you fill in to get a job
telephone or email someone

.....Fold here

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a form you fill in to get a job
a job which you have for a short time
a job which is less than 35 hours every week
a job which you have for a long time
the things they teach you to help you do a job
a person who does a job but does not get any money for it
telephone or email someone

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Looking for work outside Unit 1: Job seeking - resources

Resource 8

Advert number	Name of job or jobs	Volunteer or paid?	How many hours?	Email or phone?
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				



Resource 9 Scan the jobs ads to find the answers to these questions;

How much money is the gardener paid?

How many hours is the cleaning job?

Is the support worker temporary or permanent?

Who do I contact about the office assistant job?

Is the recycling job full-time or part time?

When does the gardening job finish?

Extra questions (if you have time)

I can't drive. Can I apply for the recycling job?

I have no experience. Can I apply for the gardening job?

Which job pays for my bus ticket?

Which jobs offer training?

If you are finished, think of two more questions you can ask about the job ads.

Answers

Resource 5

From top: Picture 1 – look online, Picture 2 – ask about a job, Picture 3 – go to the job centre, Picture 4 – fill in a form, Picture 5 – send a CV, Picture 6 – read job ads

Resource 7

The words and definitions should match as follows;

<i>volunteer</i>	<i>a person who does a job but does not get any money for it</i>
<i>application form</i>	<i>a form you fill in to get a job</i>
<i>contact</i>	<i>telephone or email someone</i>
<i>duties</i>	<i>the things you have to do in your job</i>
<i>full-time</i>	<i>a job which is 35 hours or more every week</i>
<i>part-time</i>	<i>a job which is less than 35 hours every week</i>
<i>permanent</i>	<i>a job which you have for a long time</i>
<i>ph</i>	<i>per hour (every hour)</i>
<i>temporary</i>	<i>a job which you have for a short time</i>
<i>training</i>	<i>the things they teach you to help you do a job</i>

Resource 8

Advert number	Name of job or jobs	Volunteer or paid?	How many hours?	Email or phone?
1	<i>cleaners, kitchen staff</i>	<i>volunteer</i>	<i>10 hours per week</i>	<i>email</i>
2	<i>gardener</i>	<i>paid (£7.20)</i>	<i>20 hours per week</i>	<i>phone or email</i>
3	<i>recycling operative</i>	<i>paid (£6.73)</i>	<i>37 hours per week</i>	<i>email</i>
4	<i>support worker</i>	<i>paid (£7.52)</i>	<i>15 + hours per week</i>	<i>email</i>
5	<i>office assistant</i>	<i>volunteer</i>	<i>15 hours per week</i>	<i>phone</i>

Resource 9

<i>How much money is the gardener paid?</i>	<i>£7.20</i>
<i>How many hours is the cleaning job?</i>	<i>10 hours per week</i>
<i>Is the support worker temporary or permanent?</i>	<i>permanent</i>
<i>Who do I contact about the office assistant job?</i>	<i>Khalil</i>
<i>Is the recycling job full-time or part time?</i>	<i>Full-time</i>
<i>When does the gardening job finish?</i>	<i>October</i>

Extra questions

<i>I can't drive. Can I apply for the recycling job?</i>	<i>No (You must have a driving licence)</i>
<i>I have no experience. Can I apply for the gardening job?</i>	<i>No (You will have some experience)</i>
<i>Which job pays for my bus ticket?</i>	<i>Cleaners and kitchen staff (Job ad 1)</i>
<i>Which jobs offer training?</i>	<i>These job ads mention training; Cleaners and kitchen staff (Job ad 1), recycling operatives (Job ad 3), support worker (Job ad 4)</i>